

the cloud locations and customer sites they need to reach. Network infrastructure owners should adopt a federation strategy for this fast-moving market which ensures that they maximise the value of their infrastructure. Regional fiber providers can become providers of high margin enterprise connectivity services rather than selling commoditized pipes, colocation companies can become interconnection hubs and global carriers can increase utilization both of their infrastructure and of their valuable connectivity services if they have a simple and fast way of interconnecting with one another.

1.2 Federation must overcome infrastructure owners’ interconnection challenges

A new approach to network federation must address issues of trust and technical complexity that have blocked initiatives in the past. Network interconnection should be accomplished through an easily deployable, in-network technology. A cloud-based, carrier-neutral marketplace where federated network owners can rapidly discover and do business with partners should protect participants’ customer relationships and support end-to-end visibility of and control over partner networks.

A federated approach should also give network infrastructure owners access to additional revenue opportunities, for example, by enabling them to provide new services to enterprise customers, such as connectivity to cloud on-ramps, SaaS services, GPU as a service, cloud storage and other capabilities as the cloud and AI market evolves.

This paper discusses the opportunities that a new era of network federation presents and lays out the requirements for a federation solution which will maximise the benefits for different types of network infrastructure owners.



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